forces one by one. [1]

It is precisely through employing these tactics that the Red Army was able to win the struggle to rule China. These tactics continue to influence Chinese military strategy.

In 1934, against Mao's advice, a frontal attack was launched at the KMT forces besieging the main base area in Jiangxi province, resulting in a major defeat of the communist forces. Their long, 10,000 kilometre retreat towards the north-west in Shaanxi and eventually to a new base in Yanan, came to be known as the 'Long March'. Only 8,000 of the original 86,000 troops reportedly survived the terrible ordeal of battling the elements, hunger, deprivation and constant attacks by the KMT forces. However, the Long March also established the reputation of Mao as a strategist and the correctness of the line advocated by him. At the enlarged meeting of the Politbureau of the Central Committee of the CPC held during the Long March itself, at Zunyi in the province of Guizhou, Mao emerged as the undisputed leader of the Party, and the body of his writings on policies and strategies – Mao Zedong Thought – became enshrined as the Party's formal ideology.

The Resolution has very little to say about China's external relations. It acknowledges the guidance provided by the Soviet-led Communist International, better known as the Comintern, which was set up to propagate the Soviet brand of socialism across the world. Soviet and Western archives made available recently have brought to light the important role played by Comintern representatives like Mikhail Borodin, who was assigned to China to promote the CPC and create a favourable image of the Soviet Union in the country, but these Comintern figures find no reflection in the Resolution.

The CPC was structured on the lines of the Communist Party of the Soviet Union (CPSU), with a Party congress electing a central committee, which then led to the highest policymaking body, the Politbureau. The General Secretary of the Party was the locus of the Party's authority, and this invariably created the possibility of totalitarian leadership. This happened with Stalin in the Soviet Union and Mao in China. It may happen once